Clarivate

Spec Driven Development

The Agentic Mindset

David Berger

Rapido Team · 2026

Agenda

1. **Theory**
   incl. 1.5 · Meet our SDLC agent
2. **Mission-Brief.md**
3. **Plan.md**
4. **Why is it worth it?**
5. **Coming soon**

Real life example: Email Processing III

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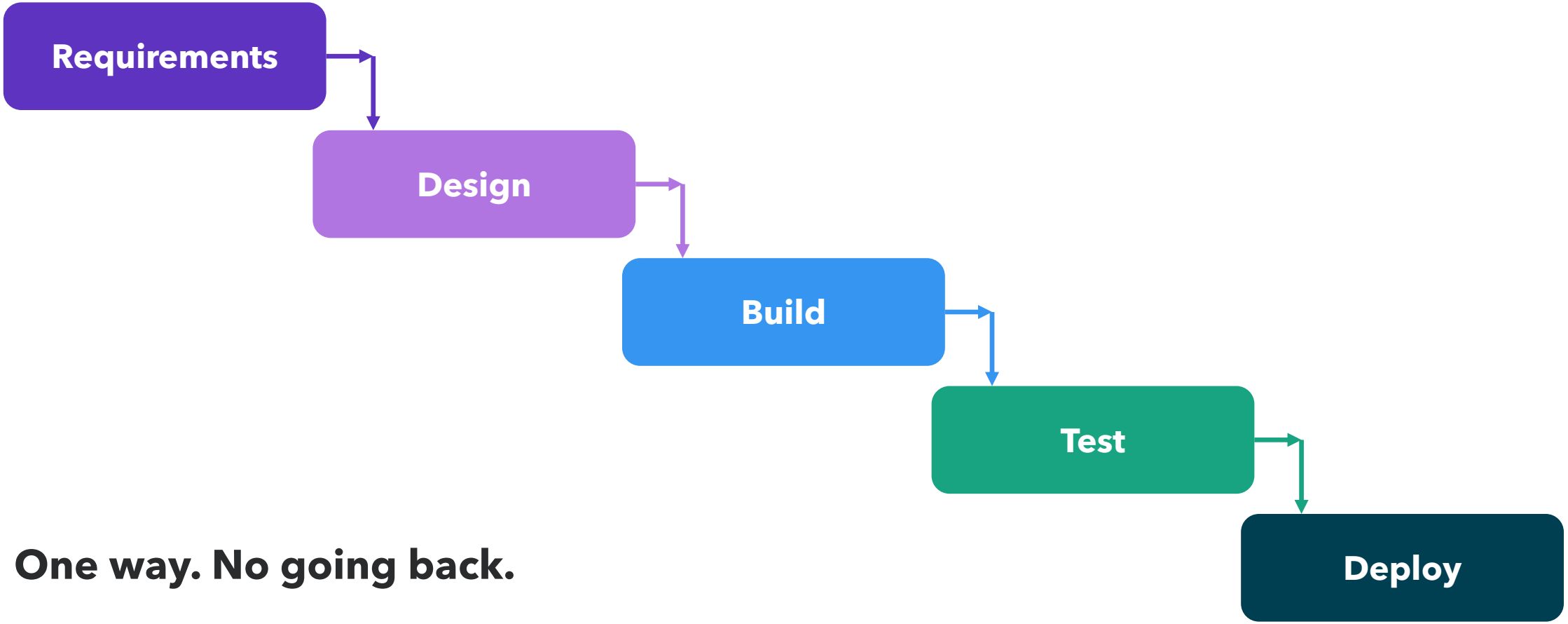
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Part 1

Theory

Waterfall · 1970

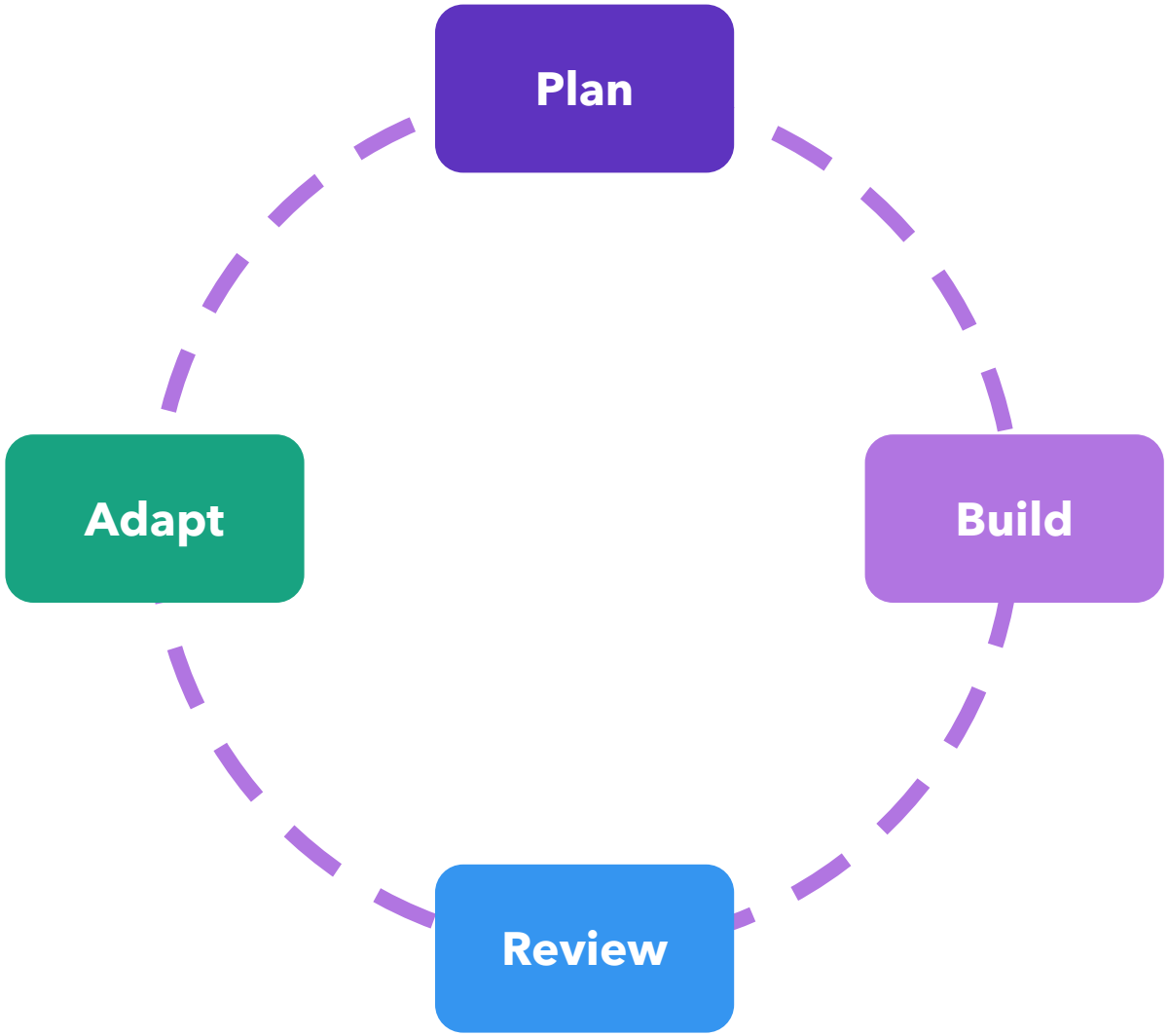


One way. No going back.

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Agile · 2001



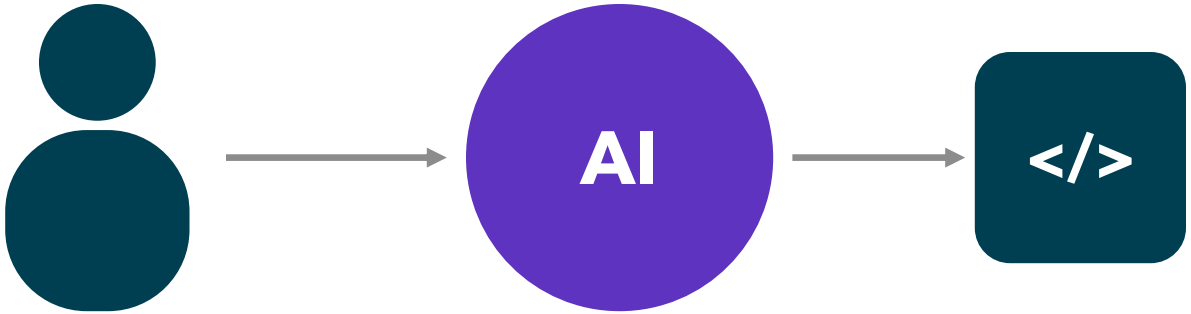
Code > Docs

Just start. Adapt.

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2023



So… what changes?

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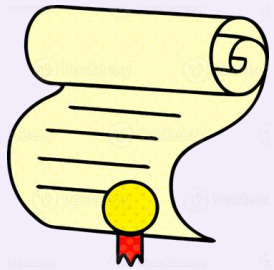
AI code ≠ Agile code

LESSON 1



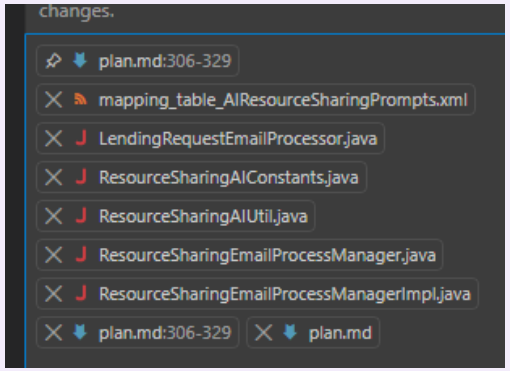
Code is cheap

LESSON 2



human language is valuable

LESSON 3

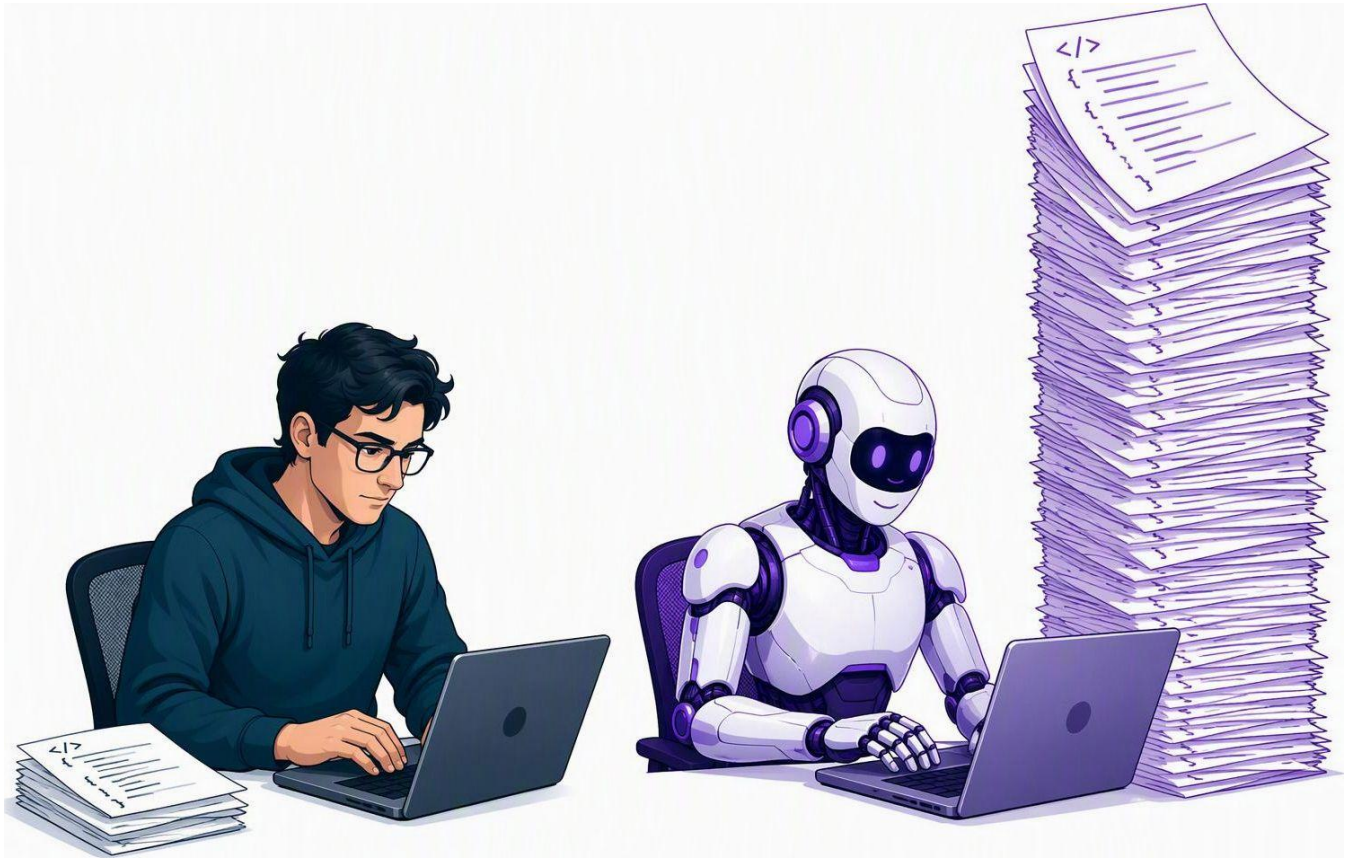


Context is critical

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1.1 · Code is cheap & disposable





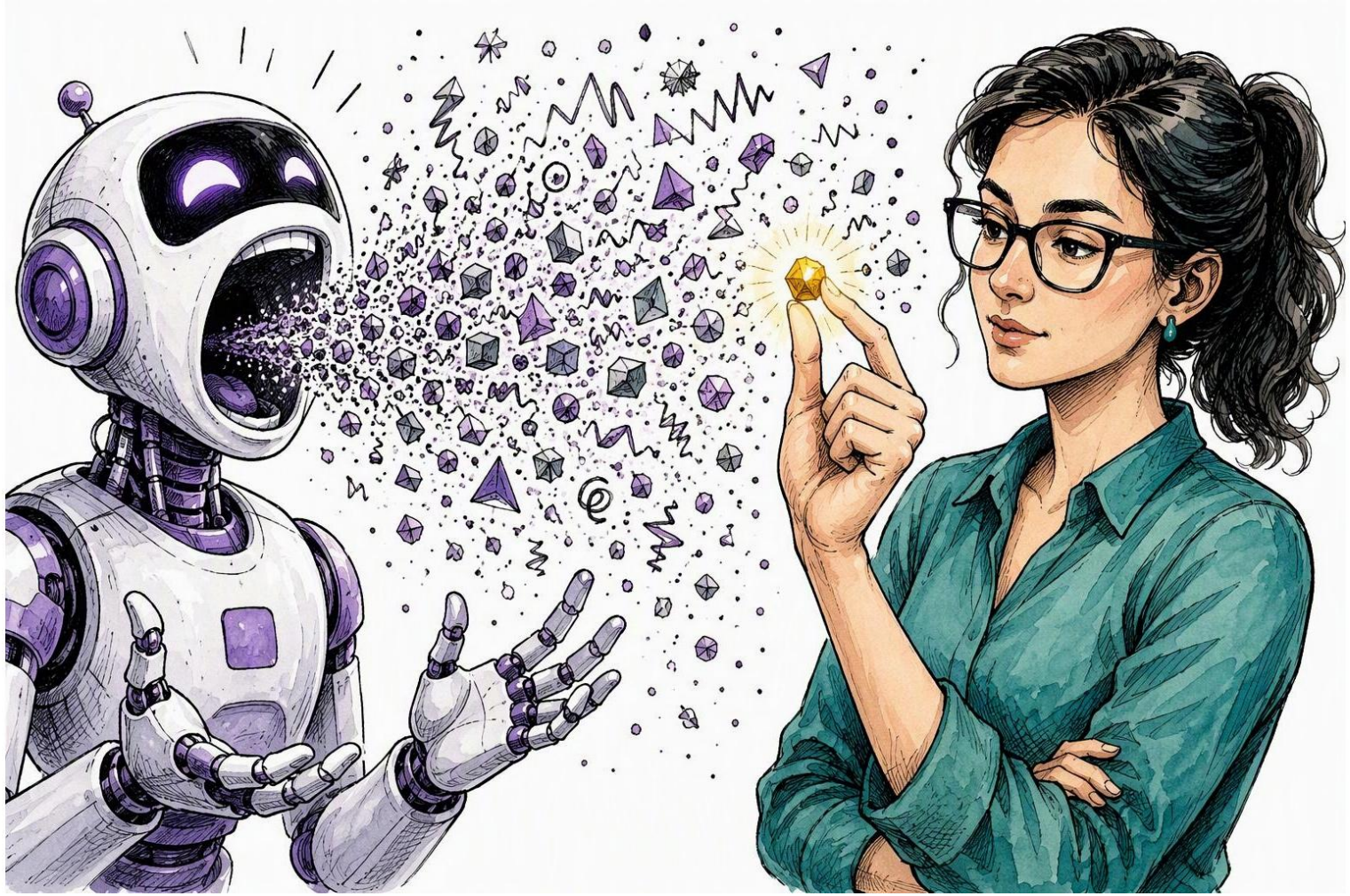
Writing code by hand

Generating code with AI

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1.2 · AI creates noise. We filter it.

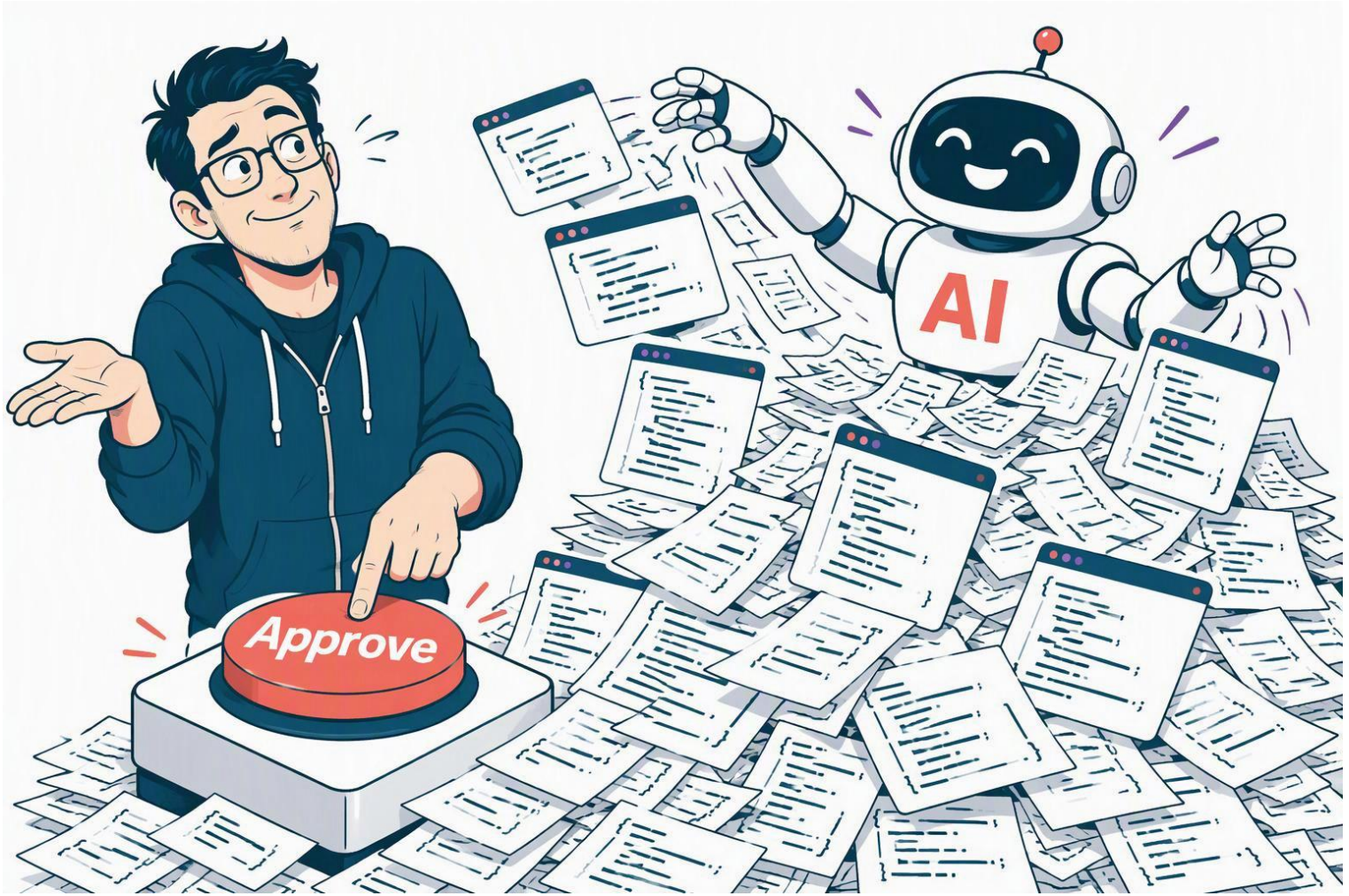




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1.3 · We understand less of our code

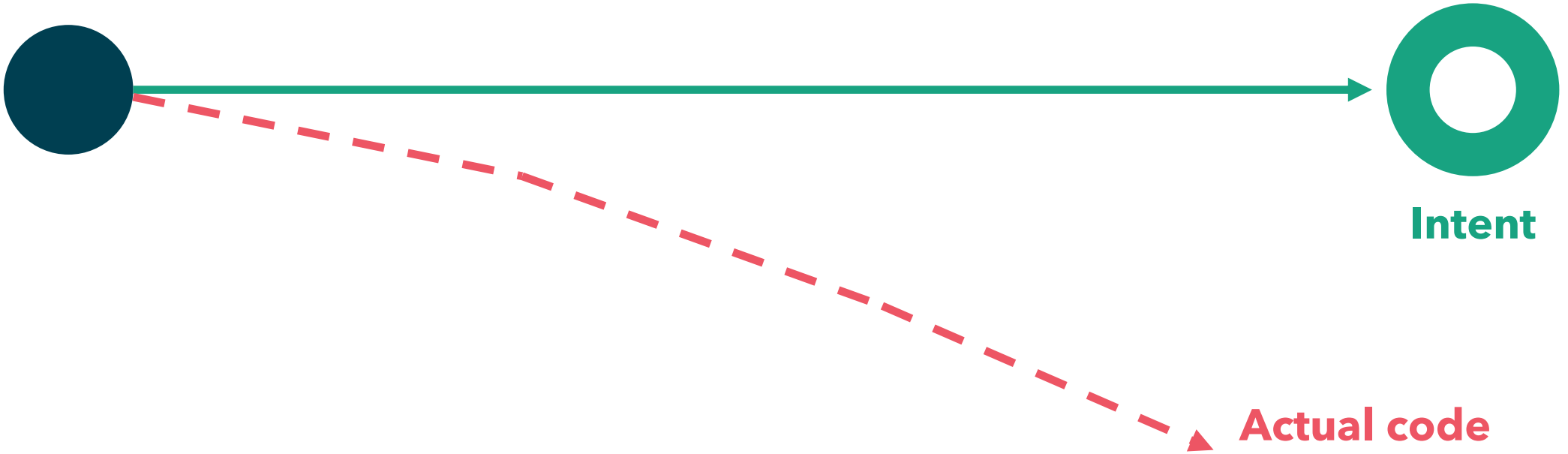




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1.4 · Code silently drifts from intent



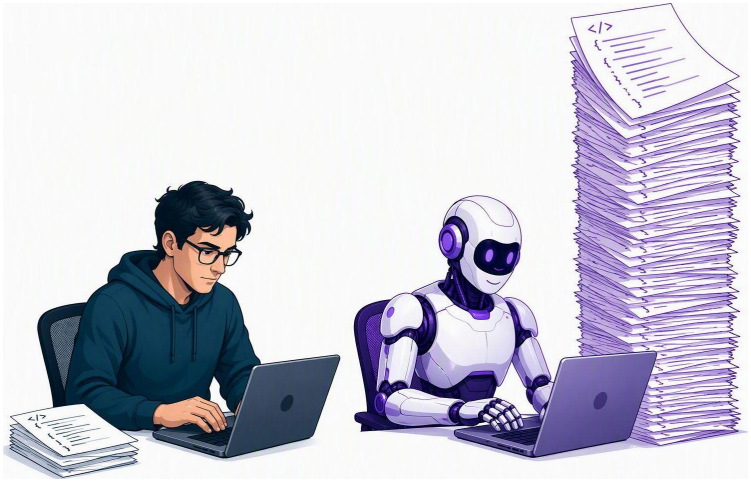


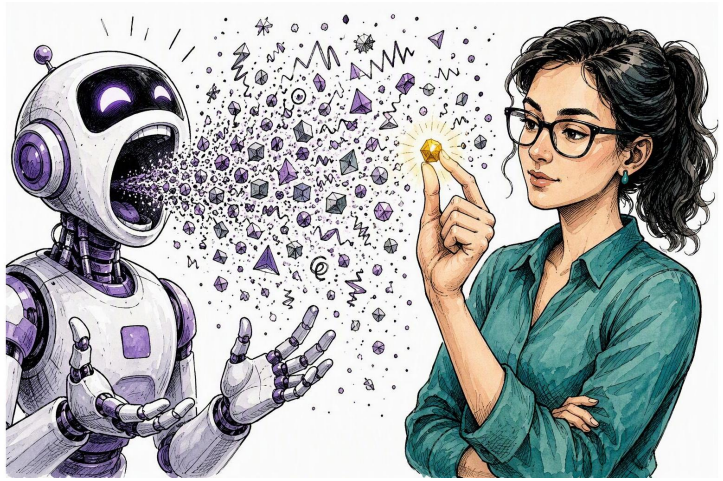
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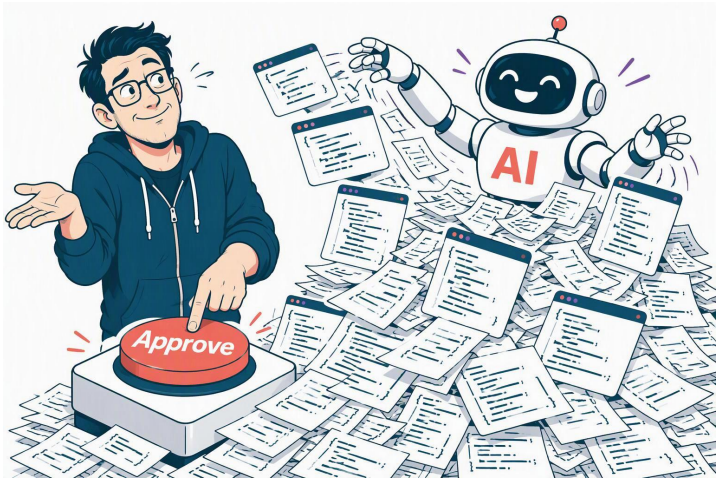
✓ End of Lesson 1 · Code is cheap



AI Creates. You Must Control.







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2.1 · Natural language is now executable

▶ Lesson 2 begins · Human language is valuable

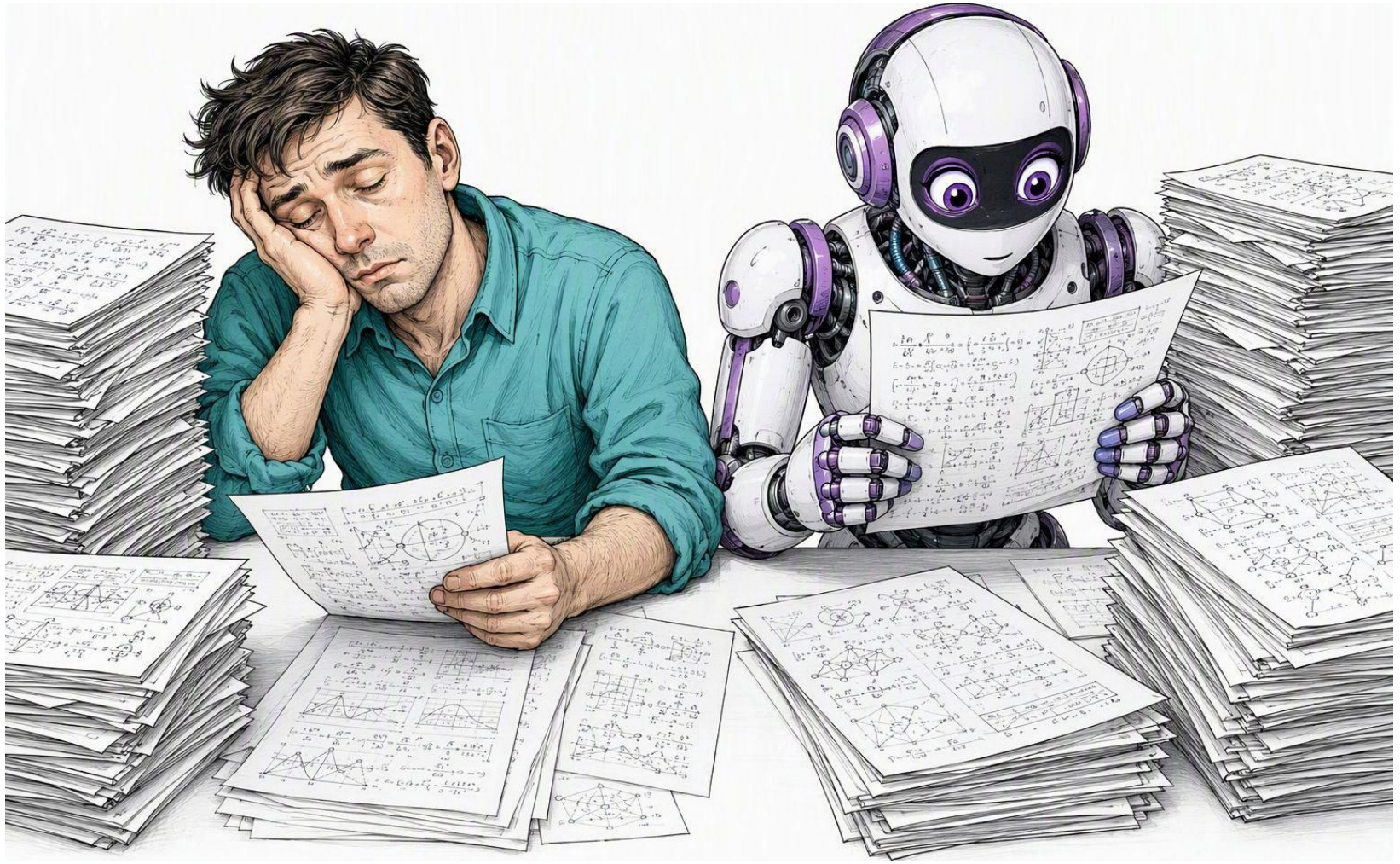




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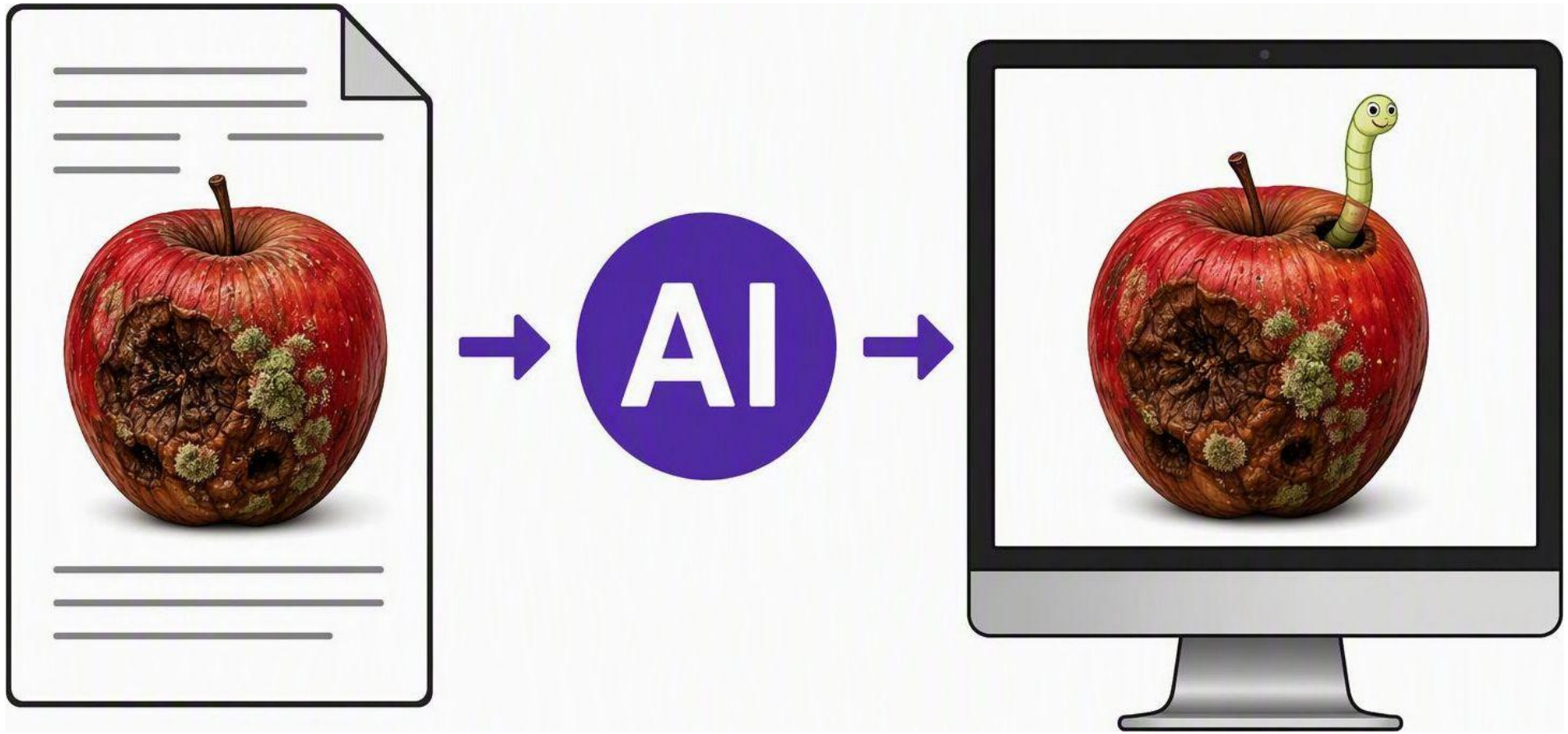
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2.2 · Docs nobody read — AI reads them all



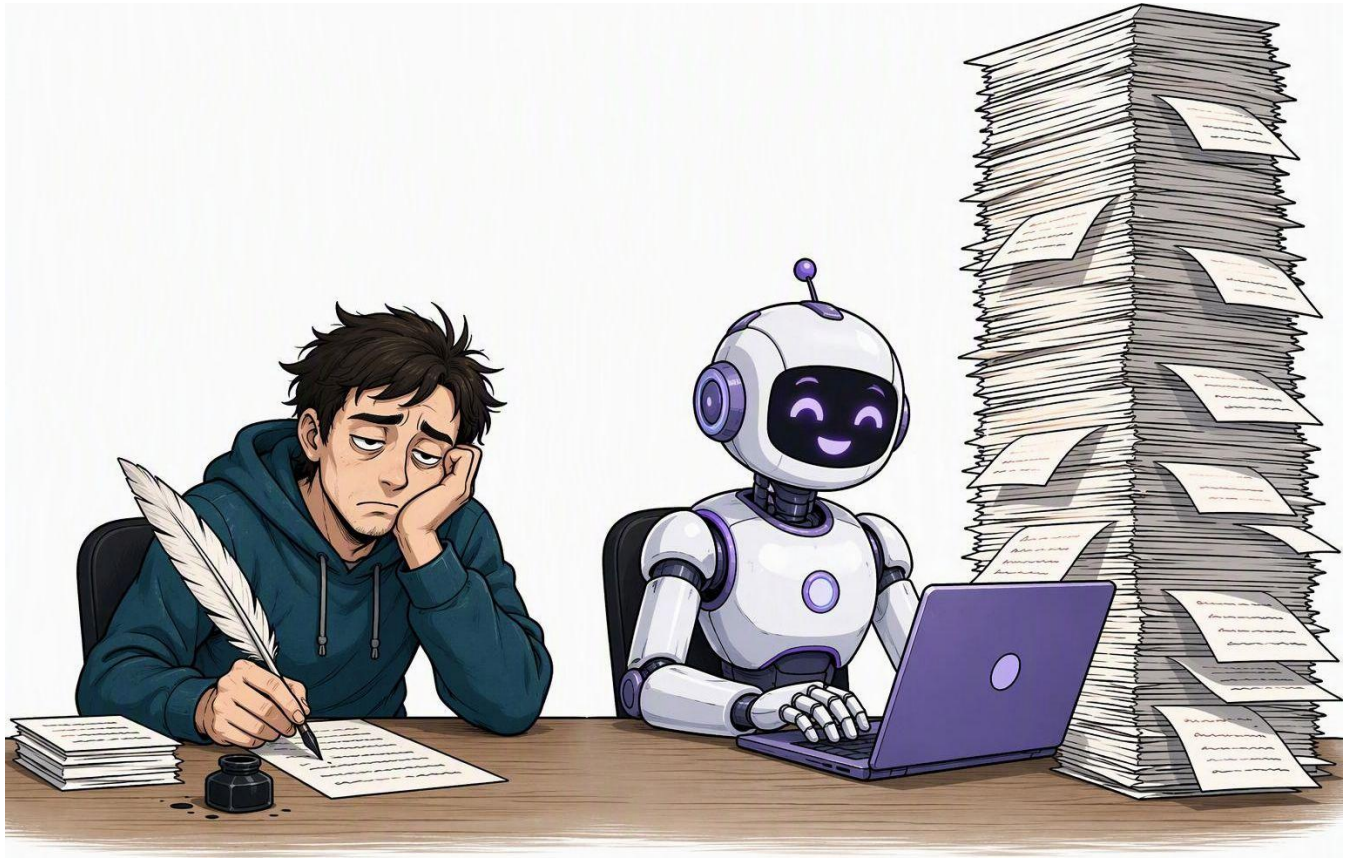
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2.3 · Bad docs ruin AI results



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2.4 · Docs take minutes, not hours



Writing docs by hand

Generating docs with AI

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2.5 · Docs update themselves



Code changes → **AI** → **Doc updated**

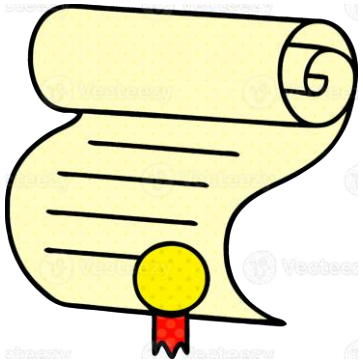
No manual maintenance

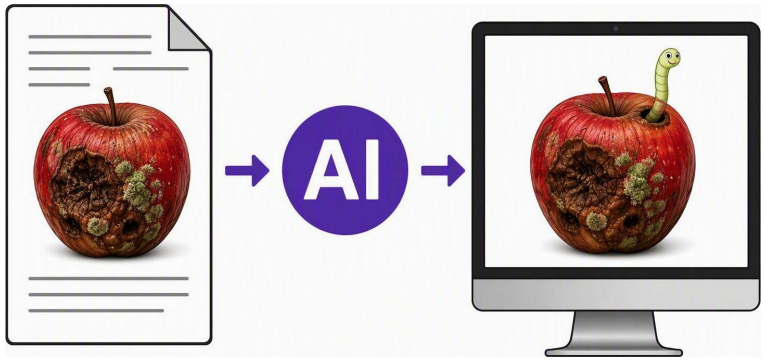
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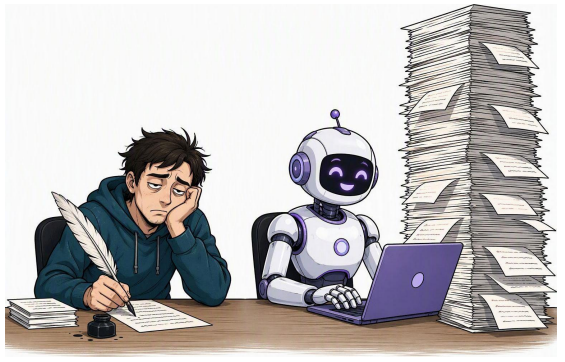
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✓ End of Lesson 2 · Human language is valuable

Don't fear documents









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Lesson Lesson 3 · Context is critical

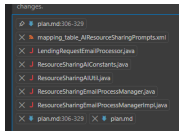
▶ Lesson 3 begins · Context is critical



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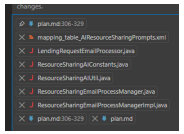
3.1 · Garbage in, garbage out

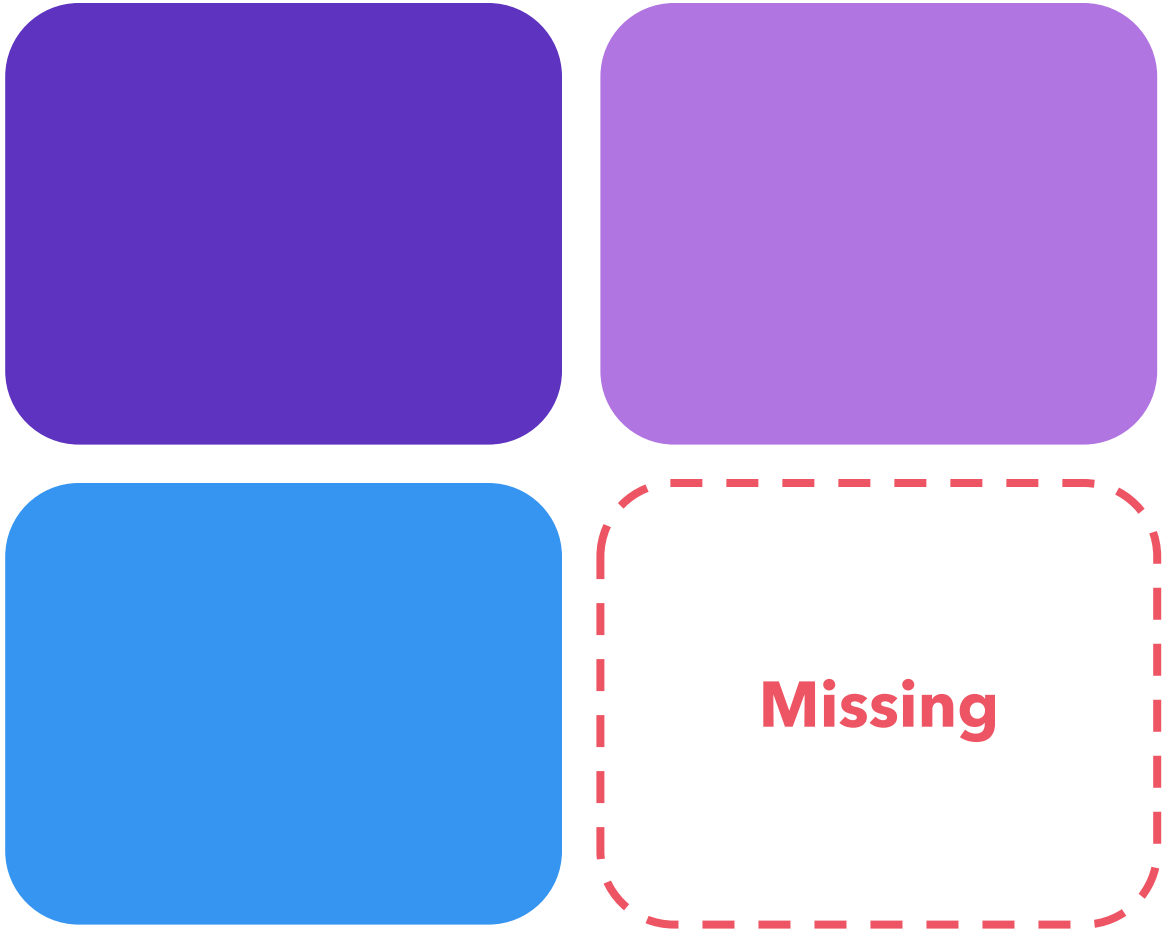




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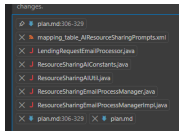
3.2 · Bad context: incomplete





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3.3 · Bad context: prompts contradict



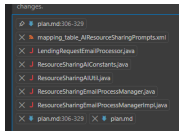
Prompt #1:
"Retry 3 times"

Prompt #7:
"Never retry"

(illustrative)

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3.4 · Bad context: prompt ≠ actual code



Prompt assumes: sync API

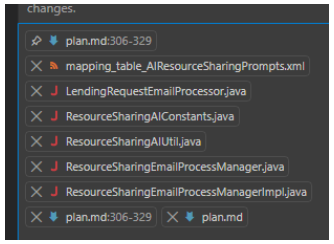
≠

Code reality: async queue

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Lesson 3 summary

✓ End of Lesson 3 · Context is critical







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The SWE role: Implementor → Orchestrator



Implementor



Orchestrator

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Many prompts. Many directions.

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One spec. One direction.

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How do we control this machine – easily?

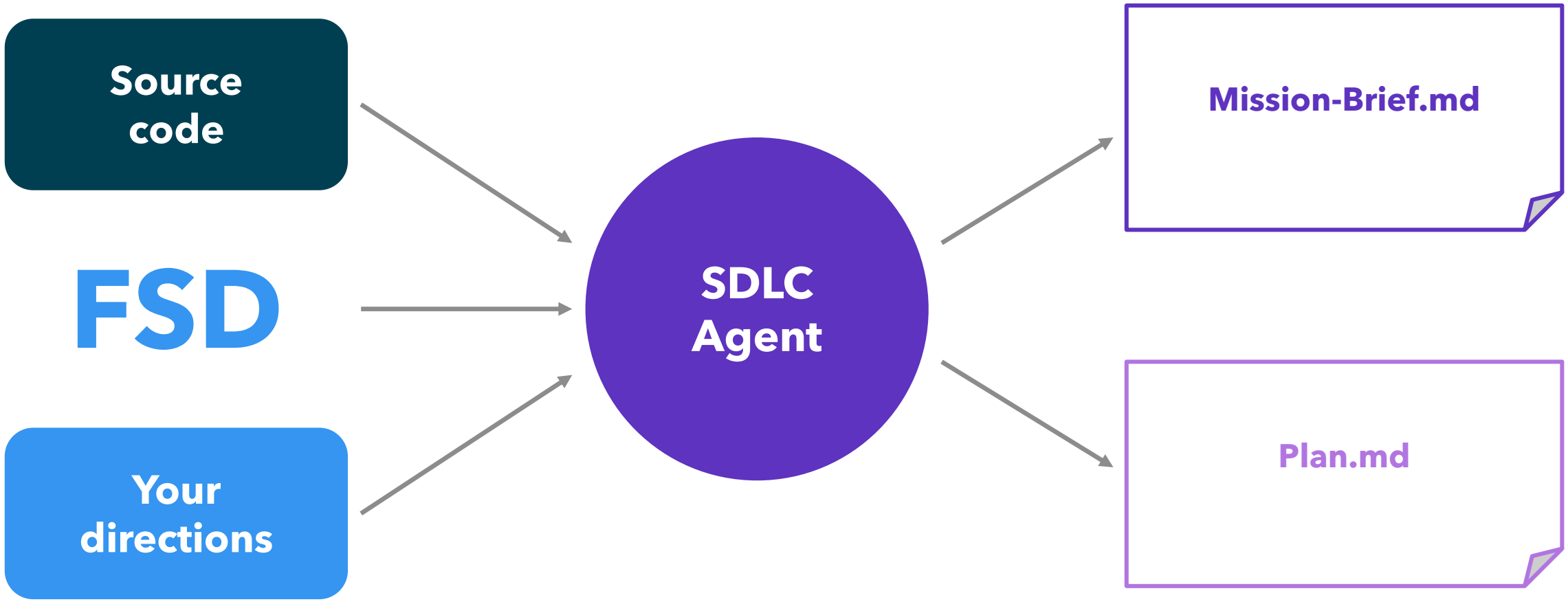
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Part 1.5

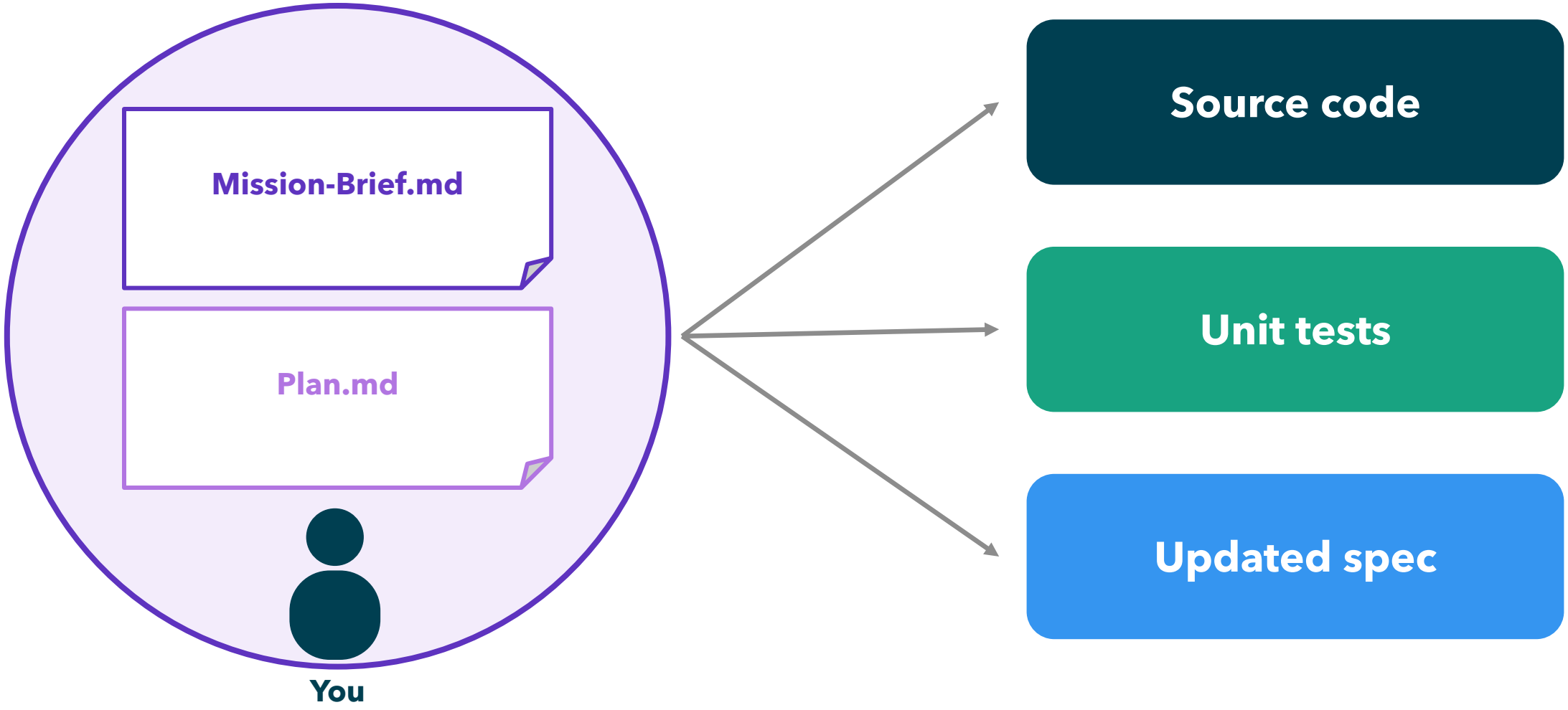
Meet our SDLC agent

Meet the SDLC agent



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Specs drive everything



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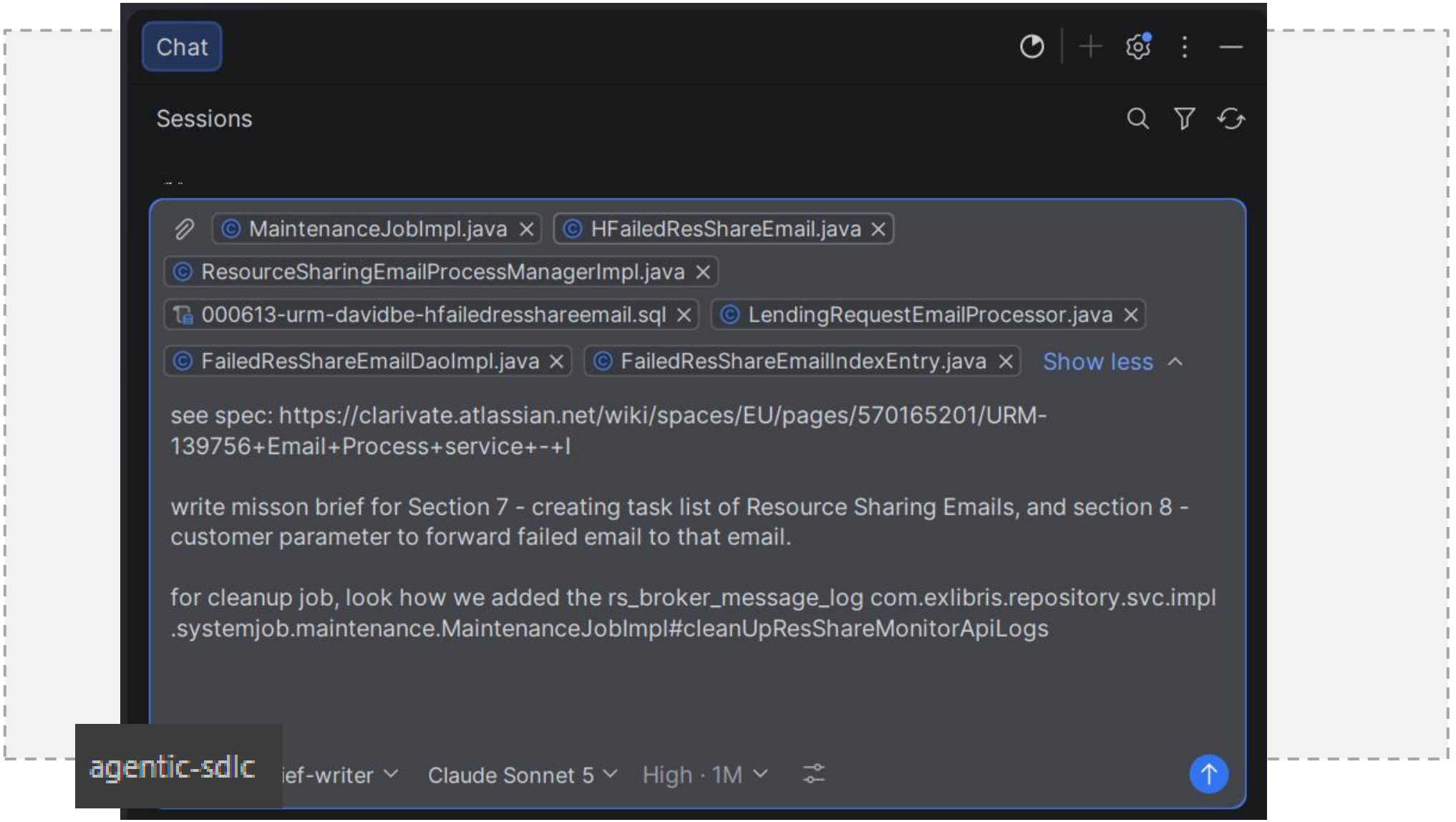
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Part 2

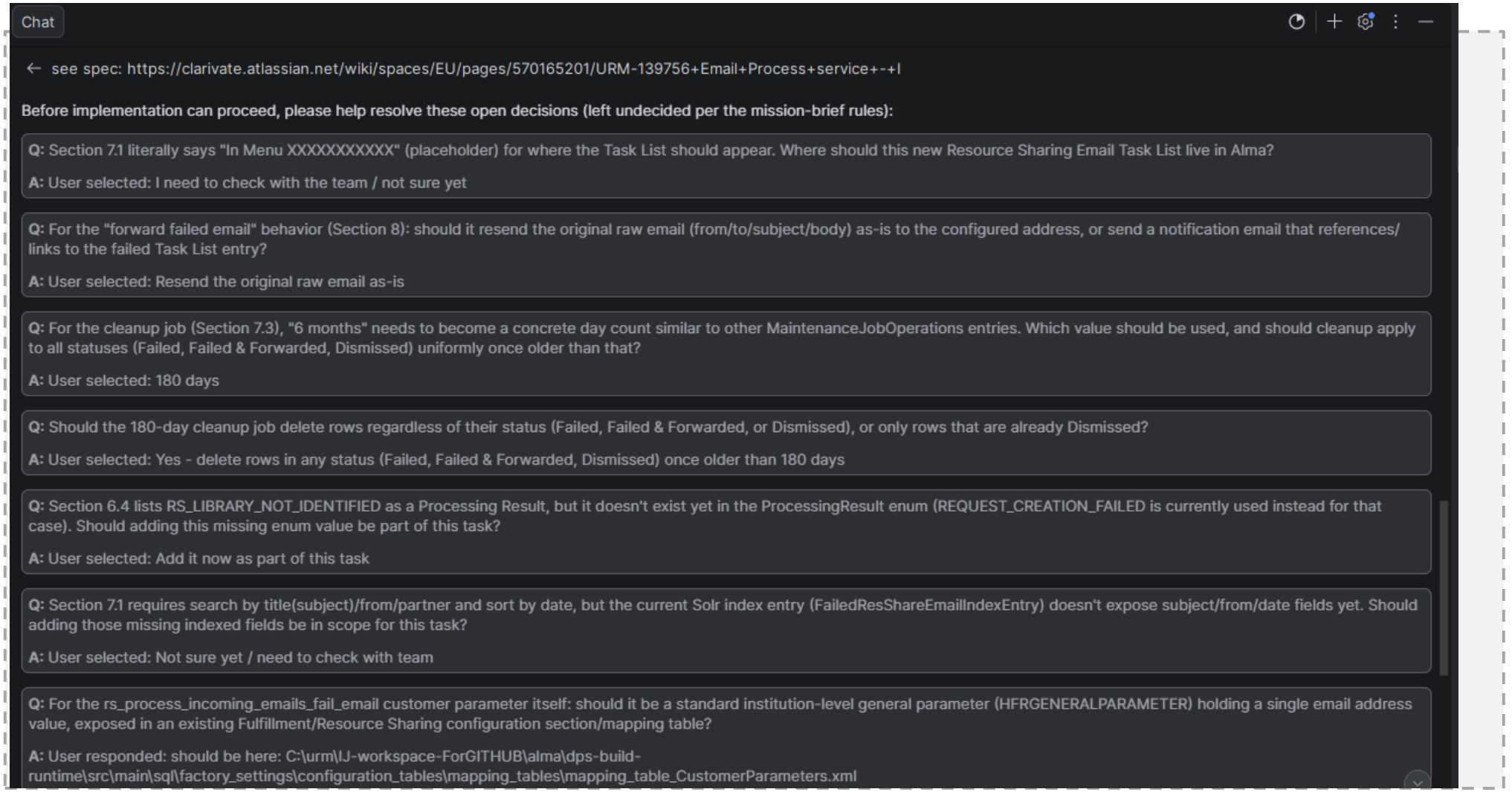
Mission-Brief.md

Step 1 · Select the agent



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Step 2 · Answer the questions



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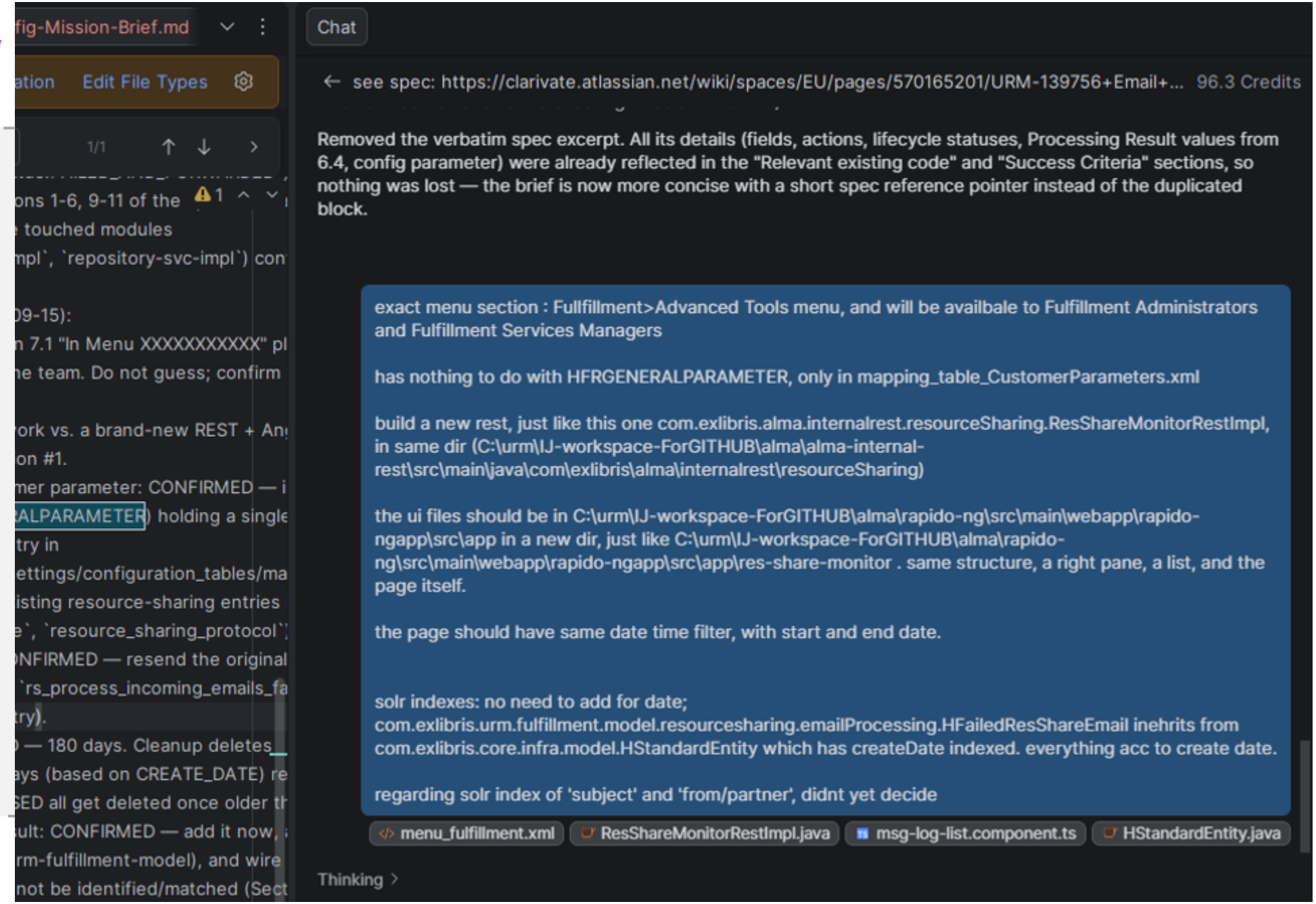
Mission-Brief.md

Live demo: Mission-Brief.md in VS Code
Presenter: pause and open the file

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Step 3 · Review



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Why a Mission Brief?

This is cool!

1

Single source of truth

2

You stay in control

3

No repeating context

4

Built as one whole, not fragments

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Mission Brief vs. FSD

	FSD	Mission Brief
For	Product	Engineers
Grounded in code	✗	✓
Kept up to date	Rarely	With every change
Lives in	Confluence…	Repo / IDE

Maybe merged someday. For now: Mission Briefs.

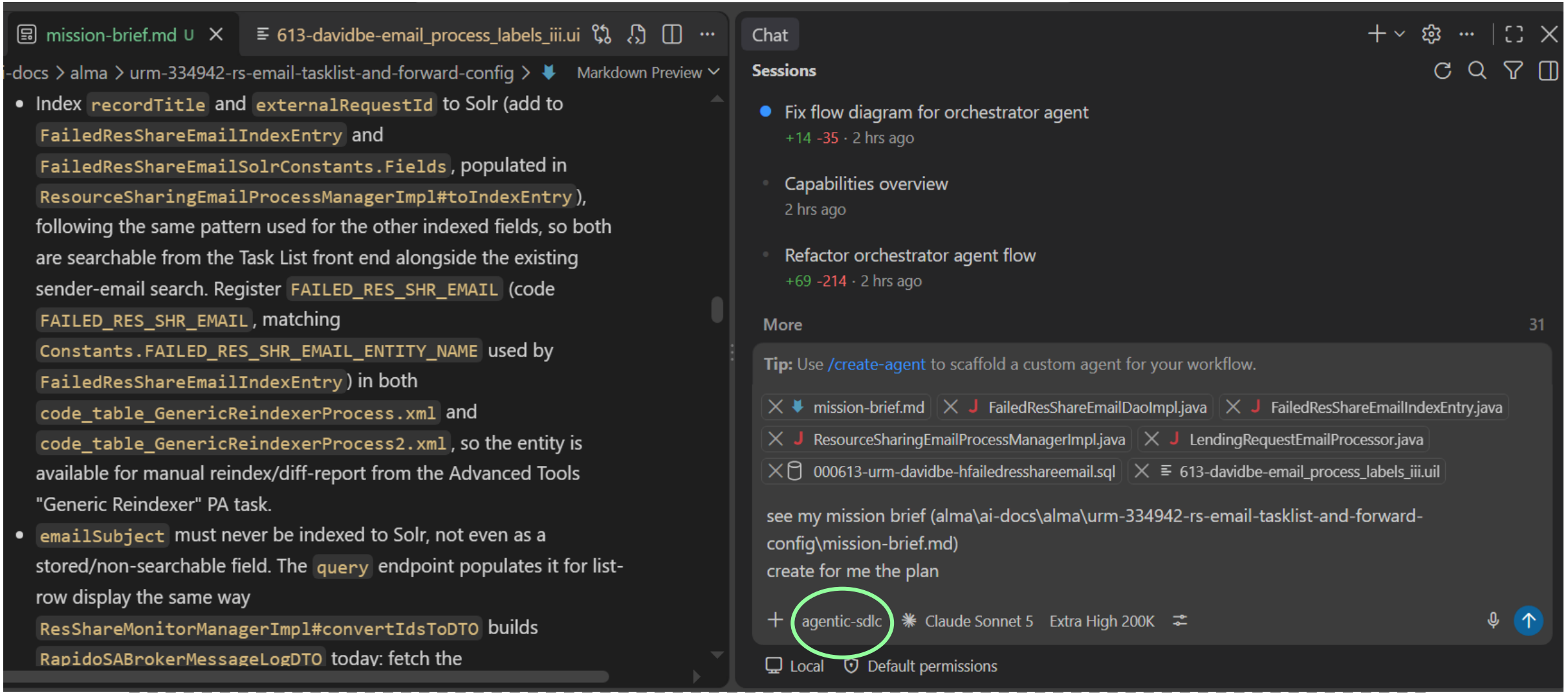
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Part 3

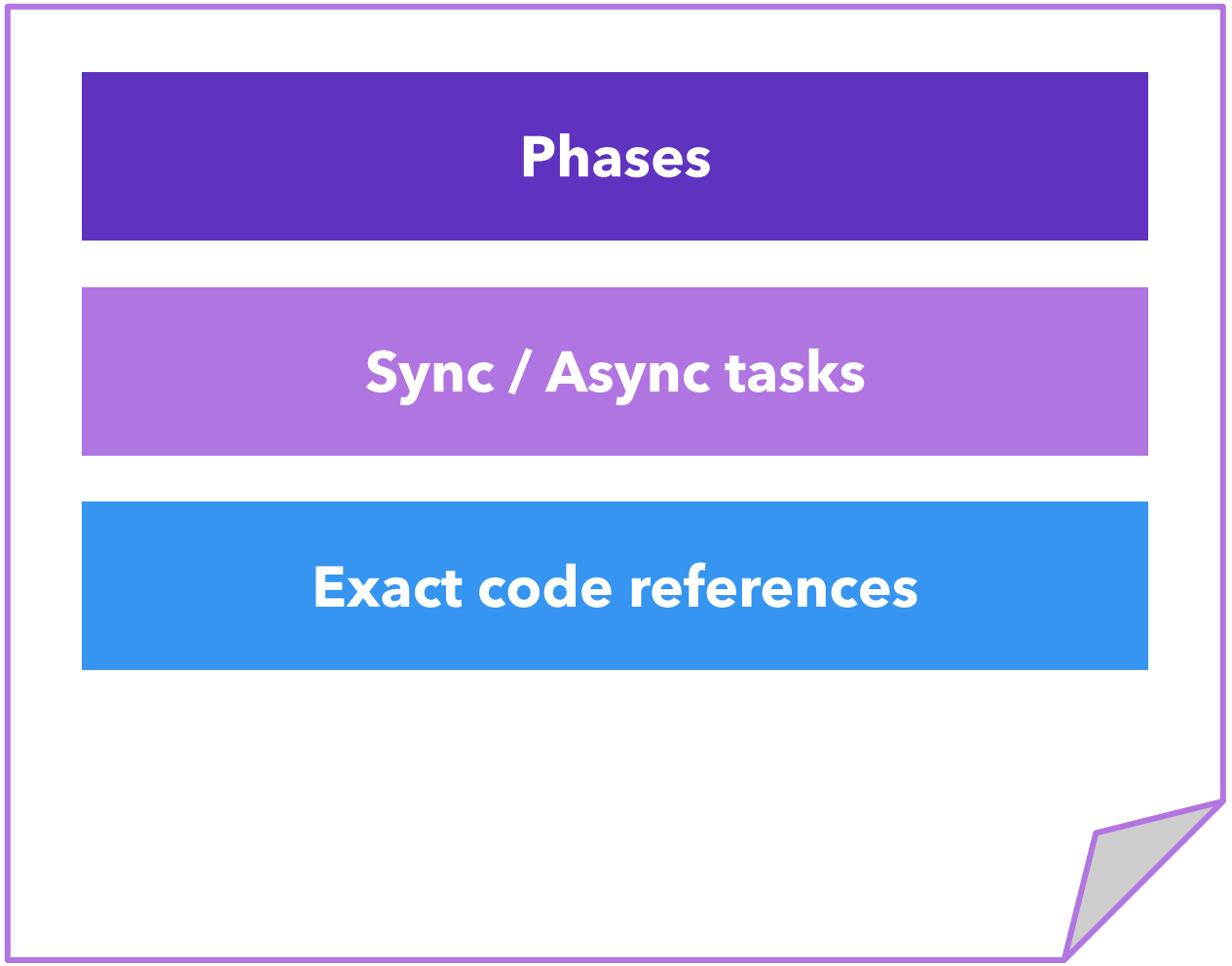
Plan.md

New chat. Clean context.



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Anatomy of Plan.md



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Plan.md

Show Plan.md
Presenter: open in VS Code

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Why both files?

Mission-Brief.md

WHAT & WHY

Overview

Plan.md

HOW & WHEN

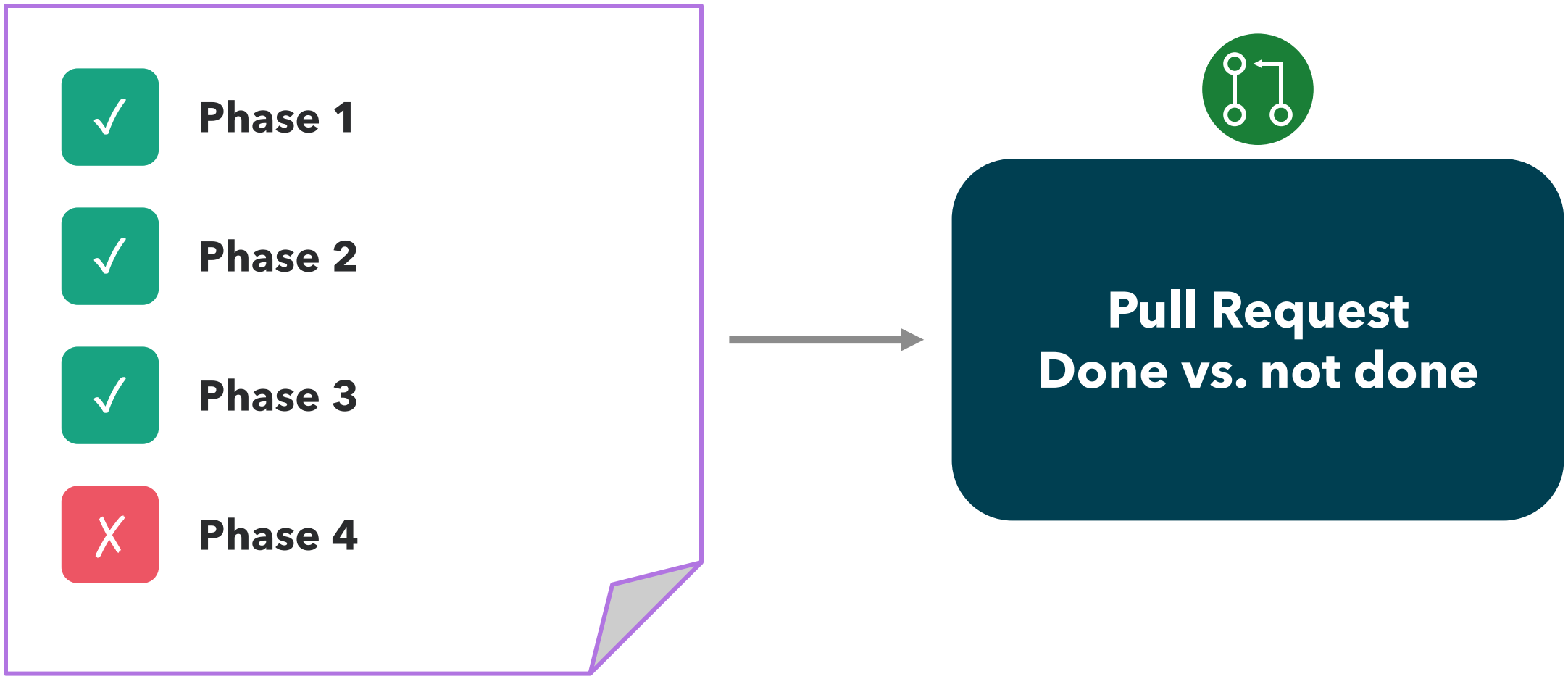
Details

** A company choice – **just be consistent !***

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Plan.md makes PRs clear



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Remember

Changed Plan.md?

Update Mission-Brief.md !!

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Remember

Changed Mission-Brief.md?

Update Plan.md!!

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Remember

Changed Source Code?

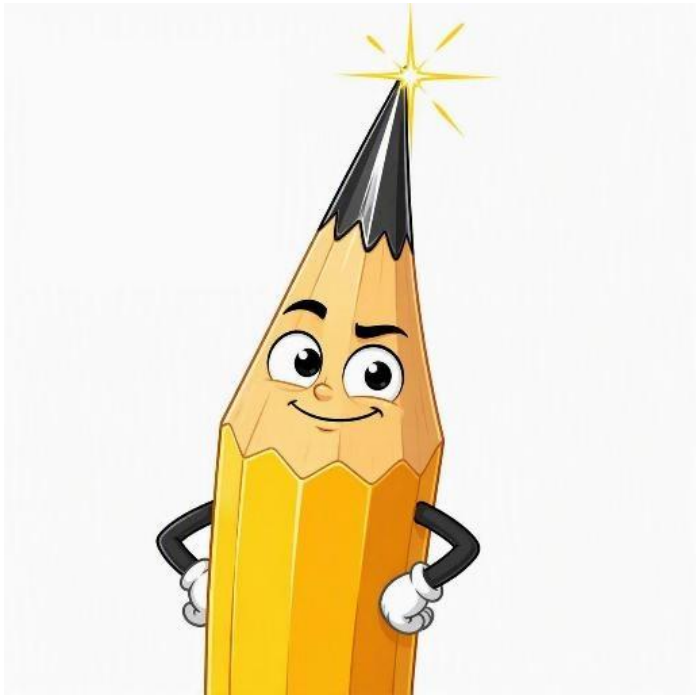
Update Mission-Brief + Plan.md!!

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Remember

KEEP THESE .MD FILES IN ANY NEW CONTEXT !!

That’s the whole point



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Summary: Mission-Brief.md vs. Plan.md

	Mission-Brief.md	Plan.md
Answers	What & why	How & when
Level	Feature	Tasks & code
Changes	**Depends**	**Almost always**
Lives in	Repo	Repo

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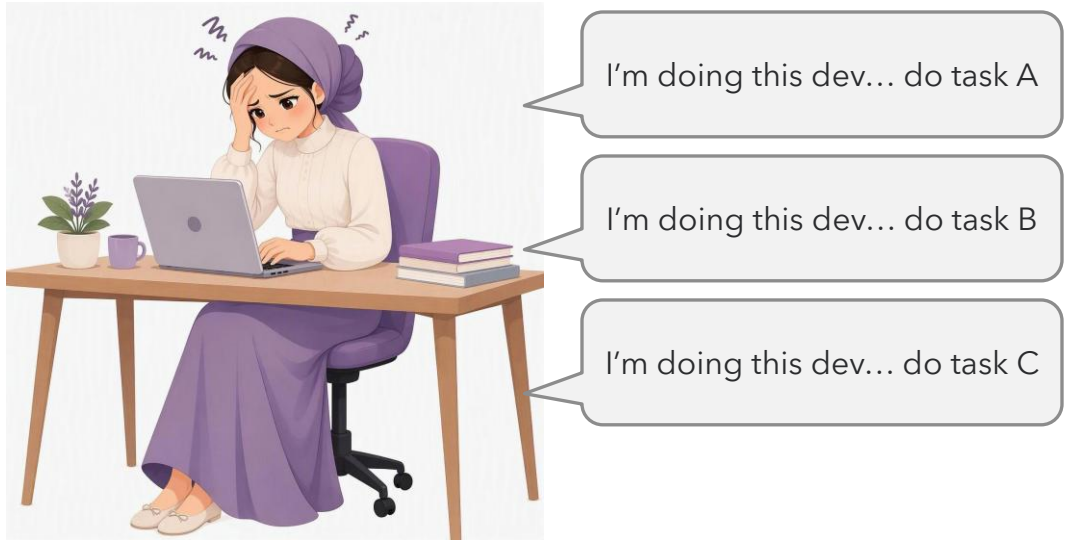
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Part 4

Why is this worth it?

"David, I have no power to write these documents!"

Less writing, not more



Ad-hoc prompting



Spec-driven

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AI · Data science · Copilot: same rule

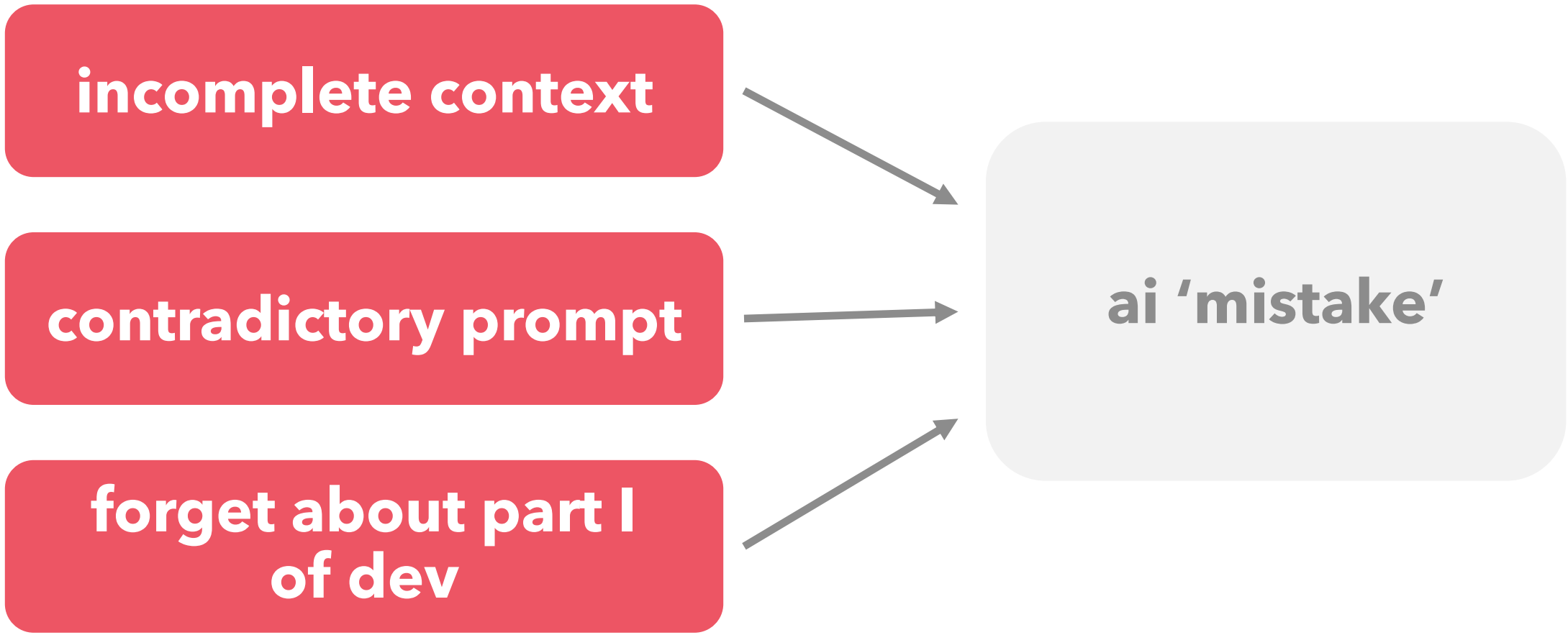
AI

Data science

Copilot



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help LLM's help each other



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Write .md files in VS Code

Screenshot: VS Code – .md editor + preview
Paste screenshot here

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This is the industry standard

265K+

devs/month on OpenSpec

A new spec created every 2 seconds

141K ☆

GitHub Spec Kit

141K GitHub stars
12.6K forks

Jul 2025

AWS Kiro

IDE with a built-in Spec mode

Sources: openspec.dev; github.com/github/spec-kit (accessed 14 Oct 2026); kiro.dev

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"I'm happy as I am. Why change?"

1 sprint

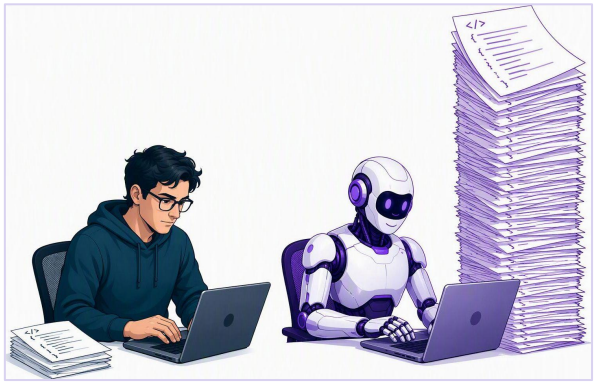


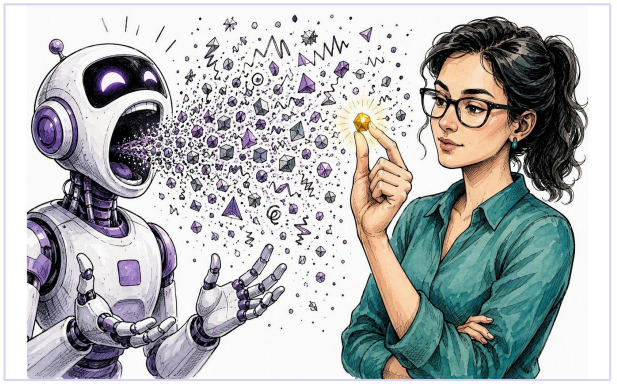
Embrace change. Just try it.

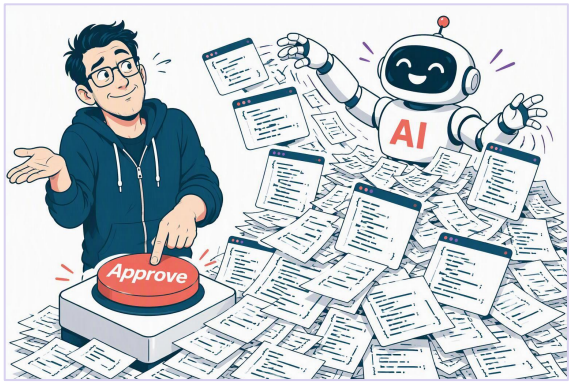
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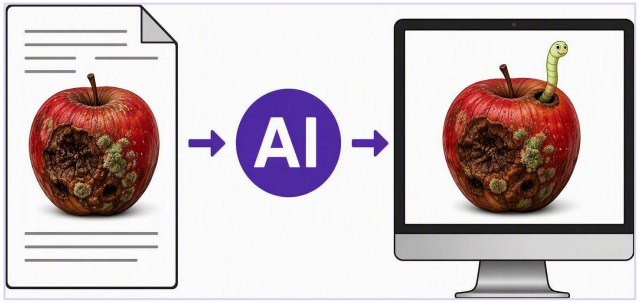


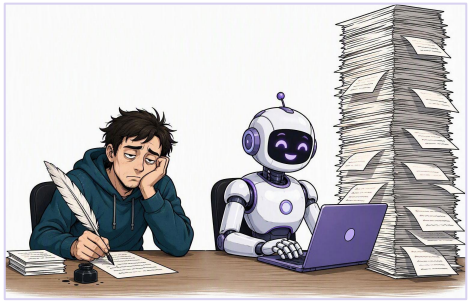




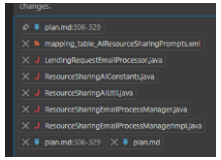










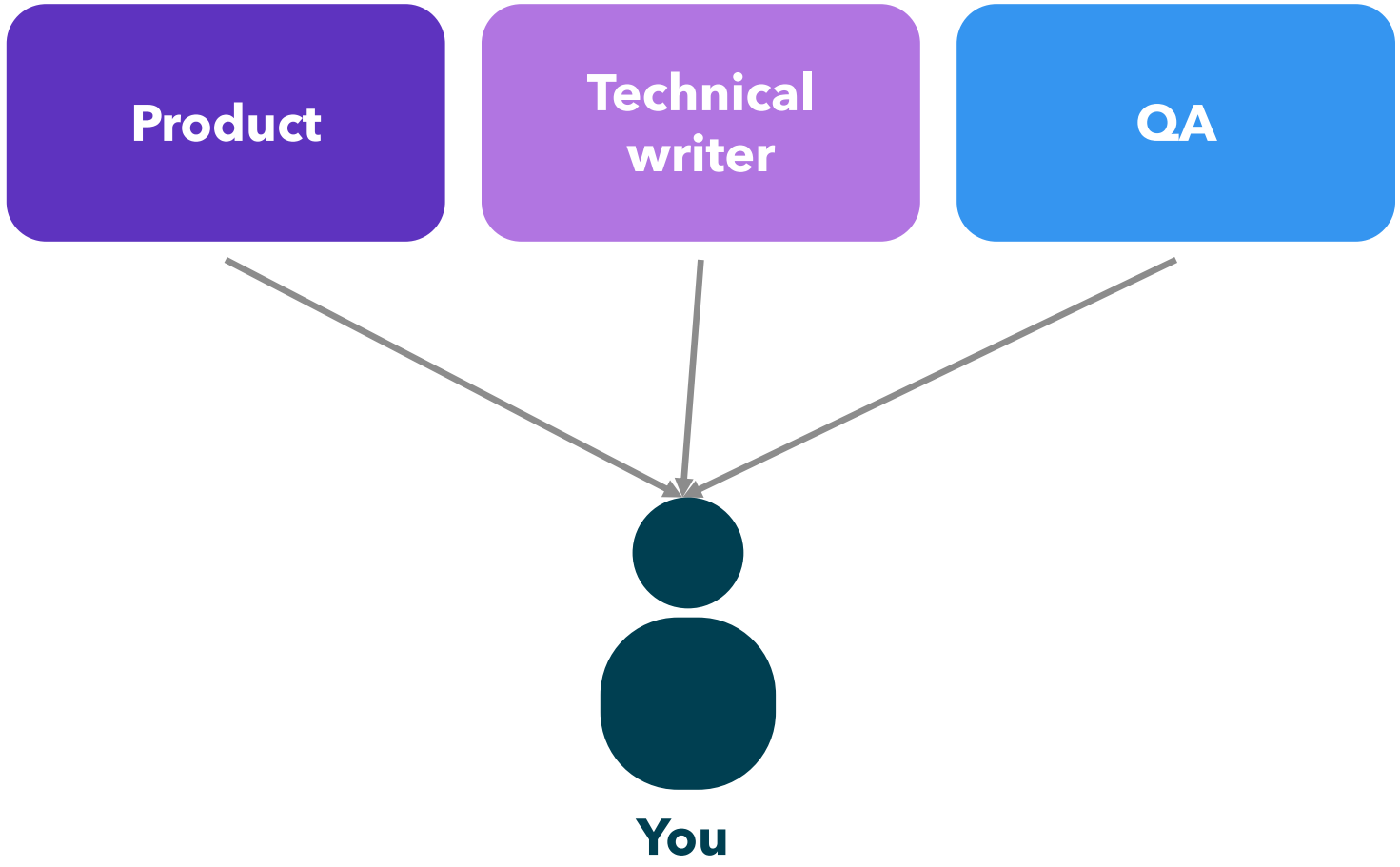






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The SWE we knew is gone



Let's practice acceptance



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Part 5

Coming soon

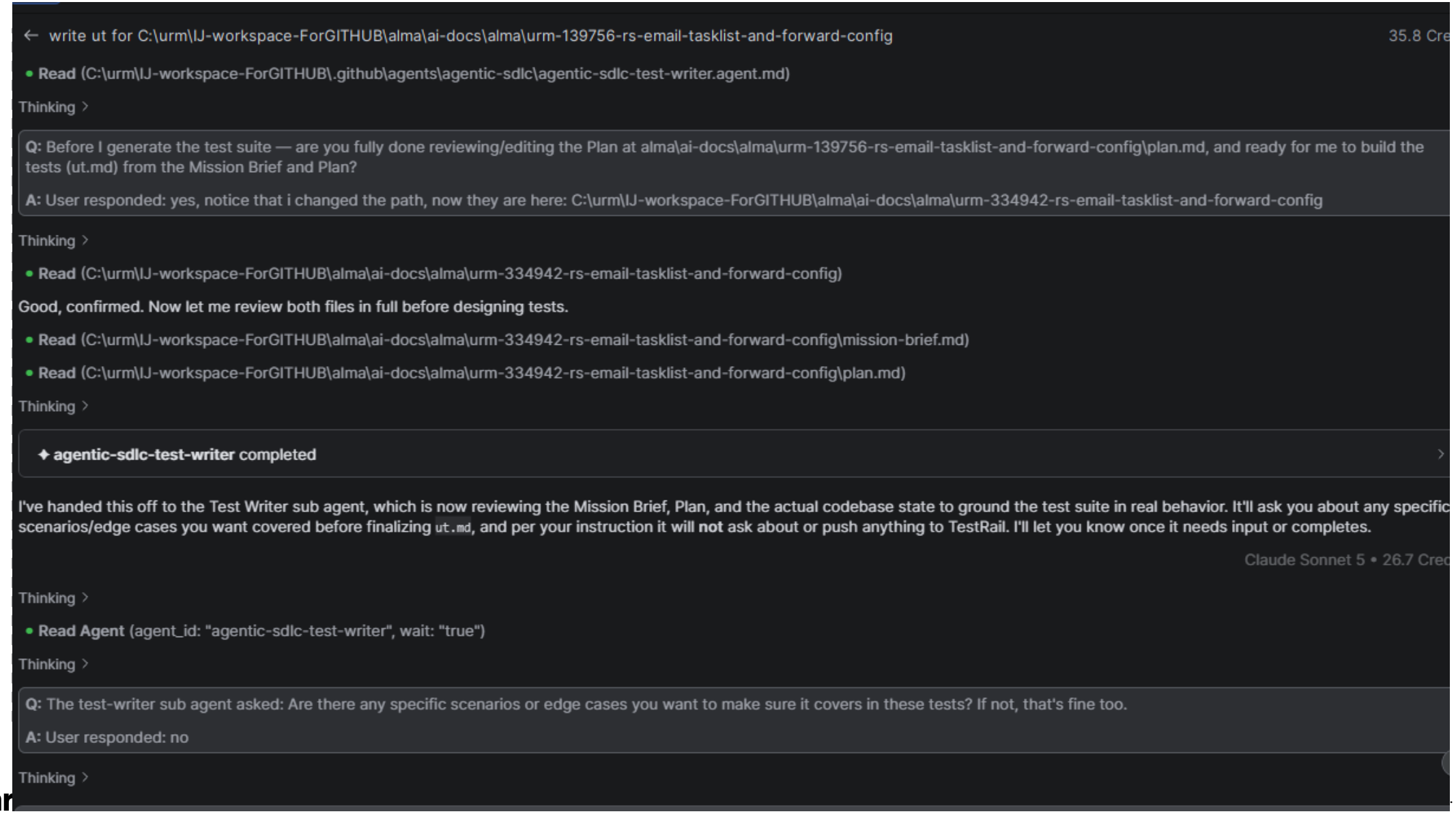
Meet our agent

Show flow-diagram.md in VS Code
Presenter: open the file

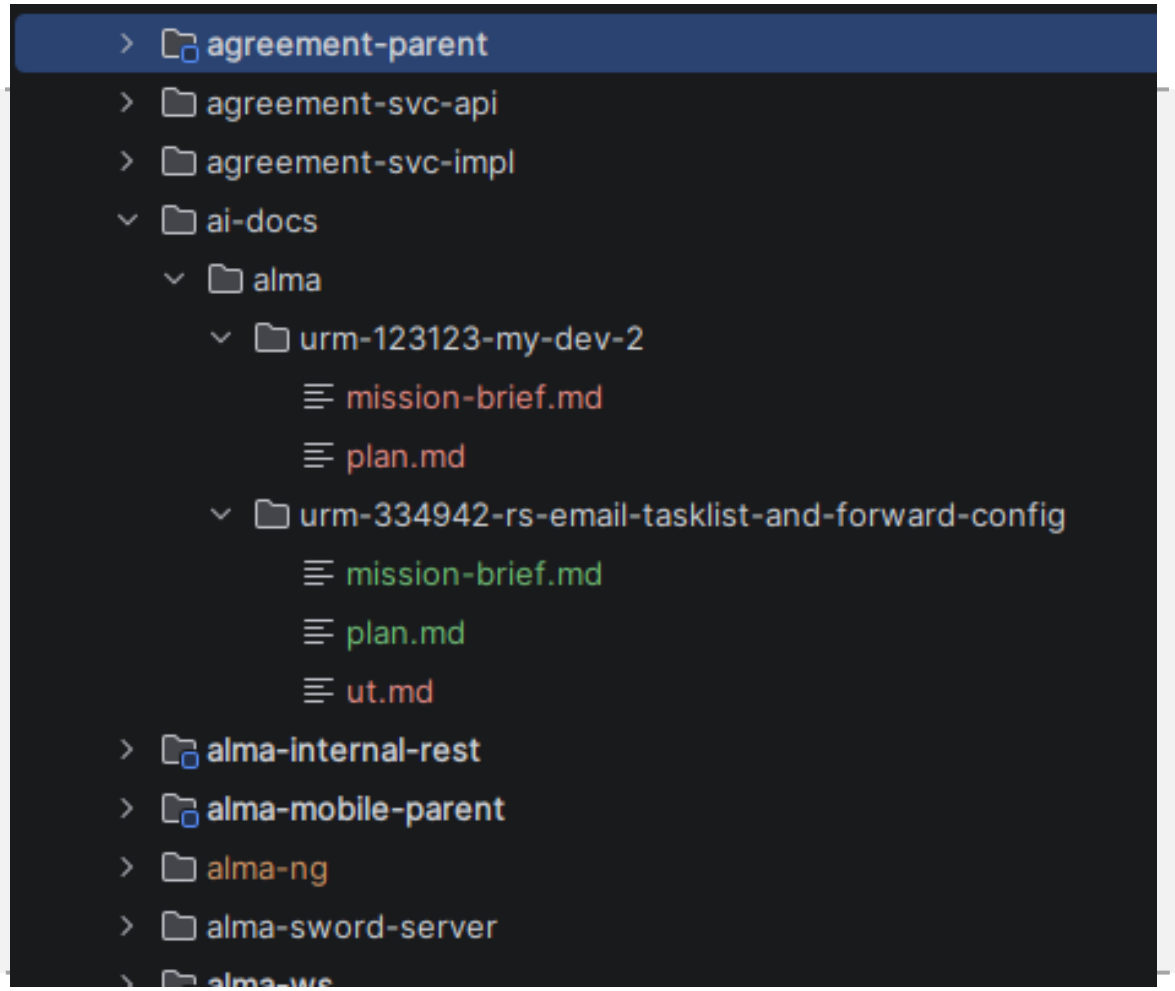
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Agent steps in practice



Directory output



Next step: push to GitHub

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Pull Requests are so clear!



"On this PR,
i did phase 2
- see commits on plan.md"

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End of dev – how do mission-brief.md and plan.md look?

Show mission-brief.md + plan.md

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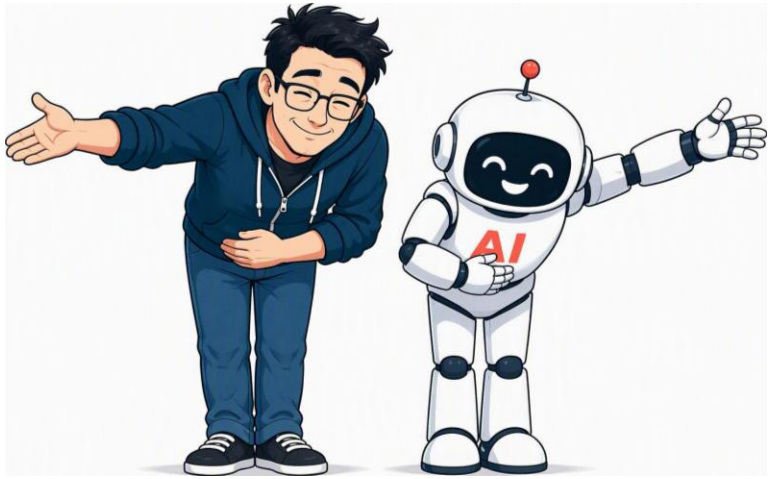
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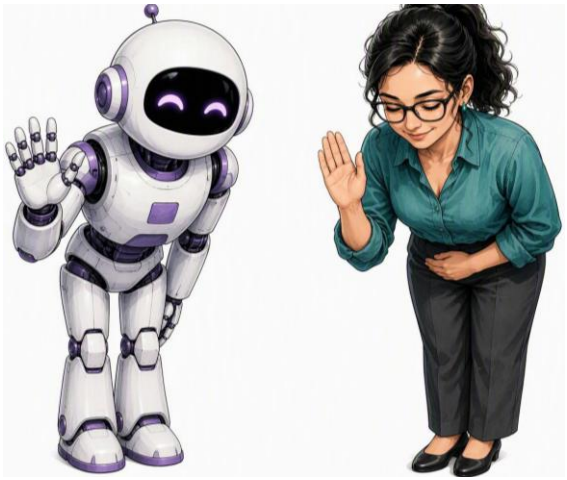
Adoption of Spec-driven development

- **Document Fixes** on previous dev
- Skills tell agents **to consult docs** before changing things
- **Product** uses docs
- **Technical writers** use docs
- **QA** uses docs
- etc…



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Thank you for listening!









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